

Letter from Deb Paulson to Aiden McCarthy

October 3, 2026

Deb Paulson

4412 Granby Street, Apt. 7, Norfolk, VA 23504

Dear Aiden,

I know I could just text you but it felt like a letter kind of week, so here you go.

I wanted to give you the full picture on my visit before I forget half of it in a text message. I am planning to come up the weekend of November 7th, arriving Friday evening on the 6th after my shift if that still works. Sandra is covering for me at the store on Saturday so I can stay through Sunday without worrying about getting back early. I wanted to confirm before I booked the train.

I am thinking the Amtrak from Norfolk to Richmond, which is usually two and a half hours and drops me right at Main Street Station which is not far from you. Can you or Nate pick me up? I arrive at 6:48 PM on Friday. If the timing is bad I can get a rideshare, just let me know.

I am not trying to disrupt your Saturday at the bakery so please do not change anything on my account. I know how the schedule runs. I will be happy to walk to Carytown and come see the place during the morning if you are okay with that. I have been telling everyone at the store about Honeycomb and half of them have looked it up already. They want to know what the sourdough tastes like and I keep telling them I am working on it.

Saturday evening I would love to have dinner with you and Nate if he is free. Somewhere you both like. Preferably not somewhere that is going to give you a flare -- I know how careful you have to be. You pick the place and I will trust you.

Sunday I thought we could just walk around your neighborhood if the weather cooperates. I have not spent enough time in Church Hill and I want to see where you live, not just the apartment but the street and the parks and all of it. Nate mentioned a coffee place on 25th Street he likes and I would love to go there with both of you if it is GF-safe.

A couple of other things: I finished reading that book you mentioned, Tender at the Bone. You were right about it. That chapter where she realizes her mother never actually enjoyed cooking -- I thought about that for days. I want to talk about it with you in person.

Also your Aunt Kathy is getting a knee replacement in December so I may be going back and forth to Virginia Beach a few times. I will keep you posted so the visit dates do not overlap with anything Nate's family has going on around the holidays.

Okay that is enough for one letter. Let me know about the train and the pickup and I will book it this weekend.

I love you. Say hi to Nate for me and tell him I am bringing his coffee.

Mom

P.S. I found a ball of yarn at the shop last week in the exact shade of blue

of your kitchen walls. I thought it was funny so I bought it. I will bring it and you can throw it away or whatever. I just liked that it matched.